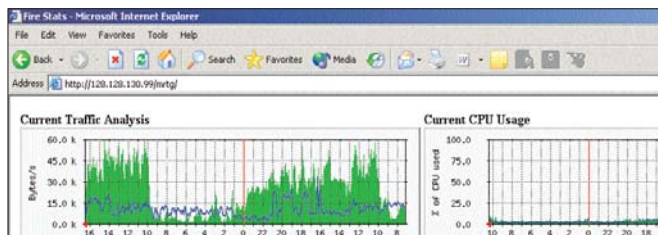


MRTG

MRTG is freeware, and is available for both Windows and Linux. As with many freeware, you need to invest time configuring. However, if the pre-requisites—a Web server and PERL—are configured and working properly, the task is easy.

Once the program is configured as a service, it keeps on updating an HTML file in a specified folder. The HTML file shows two graphs, one for network traffic and one for CPU load. MRTG does not provide any kind of management or controlling.



MRTG shows, in graphical format, the current Internet bandwidth usage, as well as the CPU usage of the server

- + Easy to configure if you have a Web server and PERL installed
- No kind of management or control provided

Price: Free
Web site: <http://mrtg.hdl.com/mrtg.html>

MRTG		B
Performance	    	
Features	    	
Ease of Use	    	
Overall	    	

1/4th AD



Jargon Buster

Network Address Translation (NAT): With NAT, you get to communicate with the external world, without revealing the internal details of the network. The fewer the details available openly, the more work a hacker needs to do.

Shared Cache: A shared cache can save recent site visits in its internal buffer for some time. If another user visits the same Web link again within this period, the software serves the page from its own buffer, thereby reducing Internet traffic and at the same time providing a performance boost.

DNS: Humans and computers refer differently to a Web site location. So when you enter a web address—say, ***www.thinkdigit.com***—the browser converts it to a numerical string like **207.68.171.233**, which can point to the appropriate host. This name-to-number mapping is referred to as DNS.

FTP (File Transfer Protocol): The language used by computers to download or upload file via the Internet, without the need for an intervening browser.

POP3 (Post Office Protocol 3): The language used by computers to receive e-mail.

SMTP: The language used by computers to send e-mail.

SNMP: Simple Network Management Protocol; a standard for gathering statistical data about network traffic and the behaviour of network components.

Tunnelling: The process by which a request on one machine is forwarded to another. It helps you secure your main server behind a firewall.

Client install: The software module in some internet connection sharing software that helps a user configure clients.

Assumed-user: Using the assumed-user principle, Internet connection sharing software display client names instead of the client's IP, just as cellphones can display the caller's name instead of the telephone number.

Proxy cascading: If you need to set up one Internet connection sharing software running under another, you need to 'cascade' the second. This means the second software does not have a direct Internet connection; it depends on the first one.

Whitelist: A whitelist generally consists of names of servers, clients, senders, etc., who can always be trusted, and allowed access to the Internet.

Info

- A Proxy acts as an intermediate agent—it forwards requests from the internal user to the external Web site and then forwarding the reply back to the appropriate user.
- HTTPS stands for 'secure HTTP'. It is responsible for transferring data on the internet securely—encrypted.
- Small Network and diagnostic utilities such as PingPlotter provide you with graphical statistics that help you identify problems associated with your network. This software is in turn dependant on common tools such as 'traceroute', 'ping' and 'whois'.
- Such a enchmarking tool as NetCPS can help you perform a rigors test of the network infrastructure.
- A Forensic tool such as Netintercept can help you know how information travels, or why it doesn't, on your network.